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Thought for 37s

0.0 Preliminary Review: Insula III in the Hellenistic-Roman Quarter of Agrigento

Data Quality Scan

Summary

The uploaded material is sufficient to begin a CBSA assessment of **Insula III** within the **Hellenistic-Roman Quarter of Agrigento (ancient Akragas)**. The sources describe an urban archaeological sector near the agora/forum and theater, investigated through archival recovery, new survey, excavation, and non-invasive geophysics from 2016 onward. Chronologically, the material spans from the **first half of the 6th century BCE** through **Late Antiquity**, with indications of continued presence into the **8th century CE**. The asset type is therefore an **urban archaeological insula / domestic quarter**, with one uploaded paper focusing more narrowly on **House III A** and its pavements. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 1–5; Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 2–3; Alaimo - Monte.pdf, pp. 1–2]

Category	Status	Notes
Location and setting	✓	Central urban sector of ancient Agrigento, near the public and religious areas, especially the forum/agora and theater; set within a terraced urban landscape on calcarenite slopes. Exact GIS coordinates are not given in the uploaded excerpts. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 1, 3]
Original function and dates	✓	Domestic urban quarter / housing sector; Insula III studied as part of the Hellenistic-Roman Quarter. Earliest occupation is stated as beginning in the **first half of the 6th century BCE**; stable occupation lasted at least to the **5th–6th century CE**, with prolonged presence to the **8th century CE** across the two papers. Dating is based on excavation evidence, material culture, and stratified urban phases rather than one single method. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 1–2, 5; Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 2–3]
Stratigraphy / development phases	✓	Multi-phase development is present: archaic occupation, 5th-century BCE rebuilding, later reoccupation, Hellenistic/Roman replanning, imperial refurbishment, and late productive/ruralized phases. Exploratory trenches and geophysics were used to test urban form and chronology. Full stratigraphic matrices are not in

Category	Status	Notes
		the uploaded set. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 2, 4–5]
Contexts (social, historical, etc.)	✓	Strong historical, urban, archaeological, and technological context is already present. Social context is only lightly visible so far through references to housing, local-community site visits, teaching excavation, and later productive reuse. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 2–5; Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 2–3]
Physical description (form / materials / technology / condition)	✓	The quarter is composed of elongated insulae organized by stenopoi/plateiai; walls in local calcarenite are mentioned, and House III A is described as centered on an internal peristyle, evolving from a pastas house to pseudoperistyle/peristyle arrangements. Modern survey methods include laser scanning, photogrammetry, GPR, and geomagnetics. Condition is only partially described. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 3–5, 16; Alaimo - Monte.pdf, pp. 1–2]
Finds and diagnostic material culture	✓	Diagnostic finds are present, including ceramics spanning from the mid-6th century BCE to Roman periods, African Red Slip, amphora fragments, painted plaster, and later productive installations in House III A. This is enough to support later value analysis, though the dataset is partial. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 15–16; Alaimo - Monte.pdf, pp. 1–2]
Research history	✓	Research history is strong: investigations began in the second half of the 19th century; major excavation history includes 1950s material and documentation; the Bologna–Parco project resumed work in 2016–2017 with systematic re-documentation and new investigation. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 1–3; Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 2–3]
Visual documentation	✓	Embedded visuals are present: site-visit excavation photo, reconstructed urban plan, and planimetric figures for the quarter and House III A. These are useful for later spatial/context analysis, though we still lack a full current photographic set of Insula III as a whole. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 2, 4; Alaimo - Monte.pdf, p. 7]

Archaeological sites note

These uploads are **archaeological research papers / excavation and survey reports**, not primary field notebooks. Dating evidence appears to combine **stratigraphy, ceramic/material typology, excavation phasing, and urban-form analysis**, with geophysics used mainly to test buried structures and planning questions rather than to date them directly. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 2, 4–5; Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 2–3]

Documentation Profile

Source	Tier	Type	Limitations
Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf	2	Research synthesis / campaign report	Strong overview, but not a full final excavation monograph; some interpretations explicitly still under study. [pp. 1–2]
Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf	2	Specialist geophysical study	Strong for subsurface methodology and research questions; limited for full architectural and social reading of the asset. [pp. 2–3]
Alaimo - Monte.pdf	2	Specialist architectural/decorative study	Focuses mainly on House III A and pavements, so coverage of the whole insula is partial. [pp. 1–2]

Site record
Tier 1 material likely exists beyond the uploads—plans, drawings, object records, and excavation archives from the 1950s and the 2016–2017 campaigns are explicitly mentioned—but present accessibility remains unknown. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 1–2]

Gaps List

- **No precise coordinates** or parcel-level location data for Insula III are given in the uploaded set.
- **No full stratigraphic sequence/table** is uploaded; phases are described narratively rather than through complete trench-by-trench records.
- **Current condition** of the insula as a whole is only partially described; preservation is clearer for selected structures than for the full asset.
- **Social/intangible context** is still thin; we have evidence of habitation, later productive reuse, and public engagement, but little on lived practices beyond that.
- **Comparative scope inside the asset** is uneven: House III A is well-described, while other houses in Insula III remain less fully characterized in the uploaded set.
- **Document scope classification**:
  - *Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf* = **A** asset-specific
  - *Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf* = **A** asset-specific
  - *Alaimo - Monte.pdf* = **B** narrower sub-asset study (House III A within the asset)
- We have embedded figures, but **a complete current photographic record of Insula III** would materially improve later analysis of fabric, setting, and authenticity.

Suggestions for Data Completion

- Upload a **site plan with coordinates** or GIS extract for Insula III and adjacent streets/insulae.
- Upload **excavation plans/sections or trench summaries** for the 2016–2017 campaigns, especially where early phases were identified.
- Add **current photographs** of the insula, streets, walls, and House III A so later stages can assess form, materials, and condition more securely.

- Add any **archive references or catalogues** for the 1950s excavation documentation and finds, since those records appear central to the research base.

Timeline Rule

Dated events clearly exist and must be carried into Stage 1. At minimum, the timeline should include:

- foundation/early urban occupation in the **first half of the 6th century BCE**
- a **5th-century BCE** rebuilding phase
- reoccupation between the **mid-4th and mid-3rd centuries BCE**
- replanning / new lot division between the **2nd and 1st centuries BCE**
- imperial renewal in the **1st–3rd centuries CE**
- later productive adaptation in the **4th–5th centuries CE**
- continued presence into the **6th–8th centuries CE** 〰 from combined evidence. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 2, 4–5; Alaimo - Monte.pdf, pp. 1–2]

Certainty Notations

No major blocker prevents Stage 1. The main uncertainties are:

- exact coordinates and full present condition: 💭
- full extent and sequence of earliest urban phases across the whole insula: 💭
- continuity into the **8th century CE** as a site-wide condition rather than localized evidence: 〰 based on combined statements from the uploaded studies. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 1–2; Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 2–3]

Anything to add, correct, or change? Continue to Stage 1?

End of 0️⃣ Preliminary Review

Uploaded a file

We can add this one

Thought for 8s ›

Yes — this strengthens Stage 0 materially.

0.0 Preliminary Review: Updated with 2016–2018 Insula III Volume

What the new source changes

The added volume is a **site-specific monographic report** on **Insula III** covering the **2016–2018 research campaigns**, with a structured scope that includes geophysics, survey, archive work, excavation, architecture, chronology, domestic forms, ritual evidence, production, water systems, conservation, and public presentation. That makes it the strongest source in the current set for defining the asset and its research base. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 4, 8, 10–20]

Revised documentation profile

Source	Tier	Type	Notes
Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf	1	Site-specific research volume / preliminary monograph	Most comprehensive source now uploade directly on **Insula III** and the 2016–2018 c presented by the editors as a **preliminary** monographic publications anticipated lat
Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nell insula_II.pdf	2	Campaign report / article	Useful synthesis and urban framing; now in scope by the 2019 volume for Insula III 1–5]
Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf	2	Specialist geophysical study	Remains key for subsurface methods and questions. [pp. 2–3]
Alaimo - Monte.pdf	2	Specialist study of House III A	Still valuable for sub-asset detail, especia house development. [pp. 1–2]

Revised confidence on the asset definition

We can now define the subject more securely as:

- **Asset: Insula III** of the **Hellenistic-Roman Quarter** at Agrigento/Akragas. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 4]
- **Assessment scale:** the whole insula, not only House III A. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 8, 10]
- **Research span covered by the main source:** 2016–2018 campaigns under agreement with the Parco Archeologico e Paesaggistico "Valle dei Templi." [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 10]
- **Chronological range currently claimed by the research team:** from the **first half of the 6th century BCE** to occupation phases datable to the **8th century CE**. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 10]

New evidence relevant to later stages

🏛️ Historical / archaeological context

The new volume states that the study is organized around the insula's **topography and chronological sequence**, explicitly linking geophysics, stratigraphic sondages, materials, and building analysis to the reconstruction of long-term occupation. This improves our basis for Stage 1 timeline work. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 16]

⚙️ Technological / methodological context

The report confirms four major knowledge streams in the first triennium: **general geophysical mapping**, **new survey**, **archive research**, and **new excavation**. This deepens the site's documentary/archival and scientific profile. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 10]

🏠 Domestic form and use

The editors identify the **Casa a pastàs** as the base housing scheme at Agrigento, accessible from the stenopos and organized around a large internal court as the focus of domestic

activity. That gives us stronger architectural evidence for later urban and typological value analysis. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 10]

🕯️ **Ritual and domestic practice**
The volume explicitly includes study of **rituals connected to the houses**, including **sacra privata** and **foundation rites** where recognizable. This is important because it gives us an evidence route toward social/symbolic value later, not just architectural value. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 16]

⚒️ **Production and infrastructure**
The editors also frame the insula through **production indicators**, **consumption**, **water supply/storage/disposal**, and later transformations into shops/workspaces. This broadens the context effect beyond domestic architecture alone. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 16]

🛠️ **Conservation and presentation**
The new source adds a clear conservation dimension: monitoring, maintenance/restoration planning, experimental protective systems such as the **"wafer climatico"** in the so-called Casa della Gazzella, virtual restoration of painted surfaces, and public interpretation. The photos on pages 17–18 visually reinforce this conservation-and-public-engagement layer. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 16–20]

👥 **Social / institutional context**
The report emphasizes the didactic and public character of the project: large multi-university participation, student involvement, and public presentations of results. The photos on pages 18–19 show on-site public dissemination and group participation, which suggests a contemporary social context of research, heritage communication, and institutional stewardship 〰️. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 18–20]

Updated gaps list

The new volume closes some gaps, but not all:

- **Improved:** asset scope, research structure, chronology range, methodological basis, conservation strand. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 8, 10, 16]
- **Still missing:** exact coordinates, full trench-by-trench stratigraphic presentation in the excerpted pages, a complete current condition survey for the whole insula, and full access to the detailed chapters listed in the table of contents. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 8]
- **Still partial:** lived social practices must still be reconstructed carefully from archaeological evidence rather than directly stated community testimony. 💭

Stage 0 revision outcome

Stage 0 now stands on firmer ground. The uploaded set is sufficient to proceed, and the new volume should be treated as the **anchor source** for subsequent stages. I would revise the earlier assessment from "sufficient to begin" to **strong enough for a credible first-pass CBSA analysis of Insula III**. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 4, 10]

Anything else to add or correct before Stage 1? Continue to Stage 1?

End of 0️⃣ Preliminary Review

Continue with stage 1

Thought for 13s

1.0 Contexts: Urban Grid, Long Occupation, and Research Visibility

💡 **Brief:** Stage 0 established that Insula III is now securely documented as an urban archaeological insula within the Hellenistic-Roman Quarter of Agrigento, with evidence spanning from the first half of the 6th century BCE to at least the 8th century CE, and with a strong 2016–2018 research base. Stage 1 turns that evidence into a readable site description, timeline, and context framework so we can see how the insula's fabric, uses, and research history shape one another before moving into value judgments. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 16; Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 1–5]

🔍 1.1 Site Description

Insula III lies within the Hellenistic-Roman Quarter of ancient Agrigento/Akragas, in a central urban position near the agora/forum and theater, within a terraced landscape of calcarenite slopes overlooking the wider ancient city. The quarter belongs to the regular street system of Akragas, with long narrow insulae divided by **stenopoi** and structured in relation to broader urban bands and terraces. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 1, 3–5; Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 19]

The insula was part of a domestic urban sector whose earliest attested occupation reaches back to the **first half of the 6th century BCE**, documented through ceramics and structural evidence. Over time, the area underwent repeated building, destruction, replanning, and reuse: archaic and classical occupation was followed by later Hellenistic and Roman housing phases, then by Late Antique productive adaptations and occupation extending to the **8th century CE**. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 10; Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 4–5]

Architecturally, the houses appear to have been organized around the **Casa a pastàs** model, entered from the street and centered on a large internal court; in House III A, this evolved through later peristyle modifications. Walls are described in local calcarenite, while pavements, painted plasters, hydraulic arrangements, and later productive installations show that the insula changed not only in date but in domestic practice and spatial logic. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 16; Alaimo - Monte.pdf, pp. 1–2; Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, p. 16]

Its present condition is that of an excavated open-air archaeological sector, partially preserved and intensively re-read through geophysics, laser scanning, archive work, and new excavation. The recent project also frames the insula as a site of conservation testing, teaching, and public communication, so the modern research setting now forms part of

how the place is encountered. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 16–20]

🕑 1.2 Timeline and Periods

Date / Period / Layer	Change in Use	Change in Structure	Notes
First half of 6th c. BCE	Earliest occupation of this urban sector begins	First structural phases attested	Based on ceramics and structural evidence. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf,
5th c. BCE	Continued occupation after earlier phase	Rebuilding at a higher level over an earlier destroyed phase	Linked in the 2018 article to a phase closed by t Carthaginian conquest of 406 BCE. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, p.
Mid-4th to mid-3rd c. BCE	Reoccupation of the quarter	Renewed use of the urban block	Presented as a distinct post-destruction occupa [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, p.
2nd–1st c. BCE	New residential occupation pattern	Reconstruction of perimeter walls and new lot division	Marks a new urban replanning/lottizzazione. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, p.
3rd/2nd c. BCE onward, House III A	House III A in domestic use	Pastas-type house established	Specific to one excavated house within the insu - Monte.pdf, p. 1]
1st c. BCE–1st c. CE, House III A	Continued domestic use	Pseudoperistyle created by adding six columns	Internal reorganization of House III A. [Alaimo - p. 2]
1st–3rd c. CE	Renewed urban/domestic investment	New structures and mosaic floors	Imperial building activity in the quarter. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, p.
2nd–3rd c. CE, House III A	Continued domestic use	Further peristyle modification with extra colonnade	Indicates continued architectural upgrading. [Al Monte.pdf, p. 2]
4th–5th c. CE	More productive/commercial use	Installation of millstones, cut basins, functional features	Shift in House III A and more widely toward pro adaptation. [Alaimo - Monte.pdf, p. 2; Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, p.
5th–6th c. CE	Stable occupation continues at least this long	Late transformations continue	One article states permanent occupation lasted the 5th c. CE; another to the 6th c. CE 〰. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, p

Date / Period / Layer	Change in Use	Change in Structure	Notes
8th c. CE	Prolonged presence continues in altered forms	Last urban occupation phases	Stated in the 2019 Insula III volume. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf,
2nd half of 19th c. onward	Antiquarian and archaeological study begins	Quarter progressively exposed through excavation	Long research history shapes current knowledg [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, p
2016	Research restarts under Bologna–Parco agreement	Geophysics, survey, archive research begin	First year of new integrated research campaign. on p. 12 shows geophysics in houses and exteri [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, 14]
2017	Investigative sondages begin	Excavation directed by prior non-invasive results	House III A and IIIM trenches are shown in the p sequence on p. 15. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, 16; Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf
2018	Conservation and public interpretation intensify	"Wafer climatico," recovery of painted/stucco material, public presentation	The photos on pp. 17–18 document both conse dissemination. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf,

🌐 1.3 Contexts

🏞️ Geographic context

Insula III occupies a calcarenite slope within the broad plateau and terraced topography of ancient Agrigento, close to the coast yet set on defensible elevated ground above a natural landing area. That topography frames the insula not as an isolated house cluster but as part of a city shaped by slope, terraces, and controlled movement. In return, the insula's long occupation helps make that terrain legible as lived urban ground rather than merely dramatic landscape. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, p. 3]

🧭 Planning: protect not only excavated walls, but also slope relationships, terrace edges, and visual understanding of elevation.

🌆 Urban context

The insula belongs to a highly structured street grid of plateiai and stenopoi, with elongated blocks and recurring domestic parcels. The grid frames the remains as evidence of planned urban order, while the insula's repeated alterations show that this order was not static but continually negotiated through rebuilding, widening, subdivision, and adaptation. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 3–5; Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 19]

🧭 Planning: retain street/block legibility across adjacent insulae and avoid presenting Insula III as a stand-alone monument.

🏛️ Historical context

The sequence from archaic occupation to late reuse places Insula III within the long urban history of Akragas/Agrigentum across Greek, Hellenistic, Roman, and Late Antique phases. That chronology frames even fragmentary walls and floors as parts of a deep urban biography; conversely, the insula makes large historical transitions tangible at domestic scale, where conquest, replanning, imperial investment, and late adaptation become visible in ordinary built space. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 10; Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 4–5]

⛏️ Archaeological context

This site is strongly shaped by how it has been investigated: older excavations, archived finds, new trenching, geophysics, laser scanning, photogrammetry, and wall analysis all affect what can now be known. The archaeological context frames the insula as both surviving fabric and research problem; in return, Insula III sharpens the significance of these methods because its interpretation depends on stitching together excavation history, incomplete exposure, and non-invasive data. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 16; Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 2–3; Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 1–2, 11–12]

⚙️ Technological context

Recent work places Insula III within a technological context of preventive and integrated archaeology: GPR, geomagnetics, laser scanning, DTM creation, and 3D/BIM-oriented data management are all explicitly part of the research design. That methodological setting frames the insula as a case where buried layout, construction techniques, and chronology are read through contemporary recording systems; in return, the site gives those methods demonstrable relevance because they directed trenches and refined architectural understanding. [Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 2–3; Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 11–12, 16; Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 12–13]

👥 Social context

The evidence points first to a long-lived domestic quarter, then to later productive/commercial reuse, and finally to a modern setting of teaching, teamwork, and public presentation. This social context frames the insula as a place of habitation, labor, and knowledge-sharing across very different periods; conversely, the insula reframes the quarter as not only elite urban archaeology but as a space where ordinary domestic routines, later work practices, and present-day heritage communication intersect 〰️. [Alaimo - Monte.pdf, pp. 1–2; Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 16, 19–20; Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, p. 2]

🕯️ Intangible heritage context 💭

The 2019 volume explicitly includes ritual study within domestic space, including **sacra privata** and foundation rites where identifiable. The context here may suggest that Insula III was not only a technical arrangement of rooms and courts, but also a setting where household identity and belief were materially enacted; in return, the insula may reframe Agrigento’s domestic archaeology as a field where ritual is embedded in ordinary architecture, not separated from it. Because the current upload gives the framework more

than the detailed ritual evidence, this remains provisional.
[Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 8, 16]

🧱 **Architectural / typological context** 〰️
Across the sources, the recurring emphasis on the **Casa a pastàs**, internal courts, later peristyles, decorated pavements, and suites of rooms suggests that Insula III participates in broader western Greek and later Roman domestic traditions. That context frames the insula as part of a regional conversation about house form; in return, the specific sequence within Insula III complicates any simple type-label, because one house can move from pastas logic toward later peristyle elaboration and then productive reuse.
[Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 10; Alaimo - Monte.pdf, pp. 1–2]

💧 **Infrastructure context**
The insula is explicitly studied through its water supply, storage, and disposal systems, described as varied and articulated according to need. This context frames the quarter as dependent on coordinated urban infrastructure rather than on isolated domestic units; in return, the remains of water management make the wider quarter legible as a functioning organism of circulation, maintenance, and adaptation.
[Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 16]

🛠️ **Conservation context**
The site is now also embedded in an active conservation context: monitoring exposed structures, testing protective systems, recovering painted surfaces and stuccoes, and developing virtual restoration for public understanding. That context frames the insula as vulnerable open-air archaeology requiring mediated care; in return, the insula gives conservation work a concrete experimental field, especially where decorated surfaces survive only fragmentarily. The images on p. 17 make that present-care layer especially visible. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 16–17]

🌐 **Thematic context: reading the ancient city through one block** 〰️
Taken together, the sources suggest that Insula III functions as a test case for larger questions about Agrigento's urban history: early city formation, domestic organization, later reuse, production, and the relationship between excavation archive and new fieldwork. This thematic context frames the insula as a microcosm through which the city is re-read; conversely, the city-scale debates increase the interpretive weight of this one block beyond its physical boundaries. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 1–5; Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 16]

Expand: neighboring insulae and street relationships, house typologies, or the ritual/domestic context — or continue.

💡 **Reflection + Continue:** Does Insula III matter more as a well-planned urban unit or as evidence of continual adaptation that unsettles the plan? Continue to Stage 2, or add/correct anything first?

End of 1️⃣ Description and Contexts

Continue to Stage 2

Thought for 20s

2.0 Values: Urban Continuity, Domestic Form, and Research Potential

💡 **Brief:** Stage 1 showed Insula III as both a planned urban block and a place repeatedly reshaped across archaic, Hellenistic, Roman, and Late Antique phases. Stage 2 now translates those contexts into defined cultural values: not just what the insula is, but what it means because of its long chronology, domestic architecture, infrastructural evidence, ritual traces, and unusually rich research record.

Historical — "Long Urban Biography"

- Earliest occupation is attributed to the first half of the 6th century BCE, with occupation continuing through Hellenistic, Roman, and Late Antique phases, and extending to the 8th century CE in the 2019 volume. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 10; Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 1–2]
- The quarter preserves evidence of rebuilding, replanning, imperial refurbishment, and later productive adaptation. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 4–5; Alaimo - Monte.pdf, p. 2]
- **Broader meaning:** Insula III carries historical value because it makes major urban transitions in Agrigento legible at domestic scale: foundation, destruction, reoccupation, Roman investment, and late transformation are all materially present in one block. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 10; Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 4–5]

Urban — "One Block That Explains the City"

- Insula III belongs to the regular street system of elongated insulae separated by stenopoi and related to plateiai within the broader urban grid of Akragas. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 3–5]
- The current research explicitly uses Insula III to rethink wider questions of Agrigentine urbanism and the dimensions/logic of the blocks. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 19; Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 2–3, 5]
- **Broader meaning:** The insula's value is not only local. It helps interpret the structure of the ancient city as a whole, so its urban value extends beyond its excavated walls to the reading of Agrigento's planned form. 〰 [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 3–5; Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 2–3]

Architectural / Aesthetic — "Domestic Form in Transformation"

- The 2019 volume identifies the Casa a pastàs as the base housing model, centered on an internal court, while House III A shows later pseudoperistyle and peristyle modifications. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 10; Alaimo - Monte.pdf, pp. 1–2]

- The insula also preserves evidence of pavements, painted surfaces, and organized representational/domestic room sequences. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 16; Alaimo - Monte.pdf, pp. 1–2]
- **Broader meaning:** Insula III has architectural and aesthetic value because it preserves not just isolated houses, but an evolving language of domestic planning and decoration across multiple periods. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 16; Alaimo - Monte.pdf, pp. 1–2]

Scientific — "Research Potential in a Partly Open Question"

- The project combines archive recovery, new survey, geophysics, laser scanning, and stratigraphic sondages to address unresolved questions about urban planning, house form, and chronology. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 1–2; Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 10]
- The geophysical study stresses that important questions remain open, especially concerning early urban phases and unexcavated areas. [Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 2–3]
- **Broader meaning:** Scientific value is especially strong here because the insula is neither exhausted by excavation nor fully resolved by existing interpretation; its significance partly lies in what it can still reveal. [Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 2–3; Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 10]

Documentary / Archival — "A Site Rebuilt Through Its Records"

- The Bologna project explicitly recovered and reorganized earlier plans, drawings, objects, and archive documentation from earlier excavations, especially the 1950s. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 1–2; Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 10]
- The recent volume itself is structured as a broad preliminary publication intended to share raw but important data with the scholarly community. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 10]
- **Broader meaning:** Insula III has documentary value because its significance is carried not only by surviving fabric, but by the cumulative archive that allows fragmented excavation histories to be re-read and connected. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 1–2; Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 10]

Social / Symbolic — "Domestic Practice, Ritual, and Public Archaeology"

- The source set points to domestic life, later productive/commercial reuse, and explicit study of household ritual including sacra privata and foundation rites where identifiable. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 8, 10, 16; Alaimo - Monte.pdf, p. 2]
- The project also includes strong public presentation and student/community-facing dissemination, visible in the photographic record of open presentations and field activity. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 18–20]
- **Broader meaning:** The insula may hold social and symbolic value on two levels: as an ancient setting of domestic and ritual practice, and as a present-day site where

archaeological knowledge is publicly performed and shared. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 16, 18–20]

Value dynamics: these values mostly reinforce one another. The scientific and documentary values strengthen the historical and urban values by making long-term change readable. The main tension is that the site's value as exposed evidence can compete with its conservation needs, especially for decorated or fragile surfaces. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 16–17]

2.1 Unified Attribute-Value-Significance-Implication Table

Attribute	Associated Value(s)	Site-Specific Meaning	🔑 Implication
Long multi-period occupation sequence **(fabric/use)**	Historical, Scientific	Rare domestic time-depth in one block	Loss of stratified sequence → weakens the insula's ability to show Agrigento's long urban biography.
Position within planned street grid **(setting)**	Urban, Historical	Explains city structure through one insula	Loss of street/block legibility → reduces the insula's role in interpreting the wider city plan.
Pastas-to-peristyle house development **(fabric)**	Architectural / Aesthetic, Historical	Domestic form visibly evolves over time	Loss of plan evidence → obscures architectural transformation and typological meaning.
Pavements, paintings, decorated domestic surfaces **(fabric)**	Aesthetic, Social / Symbolic	Shows status, use, and interior expression	Loss of decorated surfaces → diminishes how domestic life and representation are understood.
Water and productive installations **(infrastructure/use)**	Technological, Historical, Social	Connects dwelling to work and daily systems	Loss of hydraulic/productive evidence → narrows the insula to "housing" and hides lived infrastructure.
Archive, plans, finds, and recovered records **(interpretation)**	Documentary / Archival, Scientific	Site significance survives through records too	Loss of archival linkage → fragments interpretation and makes older excavations less usable.
Geophysics + new survey + targeted trenches **(interpretation)**	Scientific, Documentary / Archival	Model case for integrated archaeology	Loss of methodological traceability → weakens confidence in how buried form and chronology are reconstructed.
Public-facing research and teaching record **(use/interpretation)**	Social / Symbolic, Educational	Heritage knowledge shared in situ	Loss of public/teaching dimension → reduces the site's present civic meaning and accessibility.

Top implications: The highest-stakes attributes are the **stratified occupation sequence**, the **urban-grid relationship**, and the **documentary-archival record**. If any of these are compromised, Insula III becomes harder to read not only as a group of houses, but as evidence for the history and structure of Agrigento itself.

Expand: technological value, ritual/social value, or decorated domestic space — or continue.

💡 **Reflection + Continue:** If Insula III's strongest value lies in its long readable sequence, should conservation privilege stratigraphic intelligibility over the visual presentation of its best-preserved houses? Continue to Stage 3, or add/correct anything first?

End of 2️⃣ Values Analysis

Continue to stage 3

Thought for 13s ›

3.0 Authenticity and Integrity: Strong Spatial Legibility, Uneven Material Survival

💡 **Brief:** Stage 2 identified Insula III's strongest values in its long urban sequence, its role in explaining Agrigento's street grid, its evolving domestic architecture, and its high scientific/documentary potential. Stage 3 stress-tests those values: which parts still survive clearly in fabric and setting, which now survive mainly through excavation records, and where archaeological exposure itself has both revealed and reduced integrity. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 16–20; Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 1–5]

Integrity analysis reveals an archaeological asymmetry: **form, plan, and urban relationships remain comparatively legible, while material completeness and original domestic use survive more unevenly; documentary integrity is comparatively strong because recent research deliberately reconnects excavation, archive, and new recording.** [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 16–20; Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 2–3]

3.1 Nara Grid Table

Aspect	Attribute Description	Value Expression	Integrity
Form & Design	Elongated insula, streets, courts, house plans still legible	Urban, Historical	🟢 High
Materials & Substance	Original walls/floors survive, but incompletely and selectively exposed	Historical, Aesthetic	🟡 Medium
Use & Function	Domestic quarter later shifted to productive/commercial activity	Social, Historical	🟡 Medium

Aspect	Attribute Description	Value Expression	Integrity
Techniques & Systems	Water, survey, and construction logic remain partly readable	Technological, Scientific	🟡 Medium
Location & Setting	Insula remains in original quarter near agora/forum and theater	Urban, Historical	🟢 High
Spirit & Feeling	Open-air ruins still convey excavated urban domesticity	Social, Educational	🟡 Medium
Documentary / Archival	Archive, finds, new survey, geophysics, and publication strongly linked	Scientific, Documentary	🟢 High

Form & Design — 🟢 High
The street/block framework, internal courts, and house organization remain central to how the site is understood. Even where individual structures are fragmentary, the insula still reads as an urban unit within the wider quarter. This strongly supports the **urban** and **historical** values identified in Stage 2. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 3–6; Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 19]

Materials & Substance — 🟡 Medium
Original masonry, pavements, and decorated surfaces survive, but survival is selective. The sources repeatedly stress excavation, re-reading, conservation treatment, and recovery of fragile painted and stucco material, which implies a fabric base that is important yet vulnerable and incomplete. This means aesthetic and historical values still exist materially, but not evenly across the insula. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 16–17; Alaimo - Monte.pdf, pp. 1–2]

Use & Function — 🟡 Medium
Authenticity of original use is mixed rather than lost outright. The quarter clearly began as domestic space, but some houses later shifted toward productive/commercial functions, with millstones and cut basins in House III A and wider evidence of workshops and late functional adaptation. Historical value is strengthened by that readable change, while original domestic social value is less intact. [Alaimo - Monte.pdf, p. 2; Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, p. 5; Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 16]

Techniques & Systems — 🟡 Medium
Construction sequencing, hydraulic organization, and infrastructural logic remain interpretable, but much of that understanding now depends on expert reconstruction through geophysics, laser scanning, wall analysis, and excavation rather than on immediately self-evident standing fabric alone. Technological and scientific value therefore remain meaningful, but partly mediated by documentation.

[Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 16; Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 2–3]

Location & Setting — 🟢 High
The insula remains in situ within the Hellenistic-Roman Quarter, close to the civic core of ancient Agrigento. Its relationship to adjacent streets, terraces, and the larger urban system remains a major authenticity strength, especially for urban value. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 1, 3–5]

Spirit & Feeling — 🟡 Medium 💭
The current open-air archaeological condition still conveys an experience of excavated domestic urban space, especially through visible house remains, courts, and decorated areas. But this is now the feeling of a researched and interpreted ruin, not of an intact inhabited quarter. Because the sources provide little direct experiential testimony, this remains interpretive. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 12–18]

Documentary / Archival — 🟢 High
This is one of the site's strongest authenticity supports. The recent project explicitly reconnects older excavation records, finds, plans, and drawings with new geophysics, survey, excavation, and publication. For an archaeological site whose material history has been partially uncovered and partially removed through excavation, that documentary continuity substantially strengthens scientific and historical value. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 1–2; Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 14, 19–20]

3.2 Integrity Condition Description

Insula III's core integrity pattern is not "well preserved" versus "poorly preserved," but **readable despite selective loss**. Urban position, plan form, and long chronological sequence remain strong, so the site still expresses its historical and urban values clearly. What is less intact is the completeness of original material and use: excavation, exposure, fragility of decorated surfaces, and late functional change mean that some values now survive partly through documentation rather than through continuous fabric or practice. The site's authenticity is therefore strongest when read as an **excavated urban archive**, not as a fully preserved domestic ensemble. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 16–20; Alaimo - Monte.pdf, pp. 1–2]

I can also assess integrity across three temporal states: **at-exposure, post-excavation, and as-potential**. Would you like me to apply this?

Expand: documentary integrity, use-change authenticity, or archaeological three-state integrity — or continue.

💡 **Reflection + Continue:** When an archaeological insula is best understood through excavation records as much as surviving fabric, should documentary integrity carry equal weight to material authenticity in significance assessment? Continue to Stage 4, or add/correct anything first?

End of 3️⃣ Authenticity and Integrity

Continue to stage 4

Thought for 20s

4.0 Comparison: Insula III Between Sicilian Urbanism and Wider Greek House Types

💡 **Brief:** Stage 3 showed that Insula III is strongest in spatial legibility, location, and documentary continuity, while material completeness and original domestic use survive more unevenly. Stage 4 now tests distinctiveness: not whether Insula III is unique in absolute terms, but whether its combination of long chronology, readable urban block structure, and re-documented archaeological archive stands out when placed beside the comparison sites already named in your sources.
[Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 10–11;
Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, p. 7]

4.1 Comparison Set

Comparison logic used
I am using comparison sites explicitly mentioned in the uploaded texts:

- **Acropolis of Gela / early urban houses** [Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 10–11]
- **Porta II quarter, Agrigento** [Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 10–11]
- **Olynthus, Block A (houses A8–A9 / AIII4)** [Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, p. 11]

Criteria applied: **period**, **ensemble connection**, **research potential**, and **documentation**. These are all valid Stage 4 criteria under the CBSA comparative framework. [cbsa-appendices.md, CA-CS]

Acropolis of Gela (5th c. BCE and later comparison phases)
The source uses Gela as a comparator for earlier lot dimensions, street regularity, and houses associated with a regular grid, ambitus, and courtyard-based planning. Relative to Gela, Insula III appears less important as an isolated type-example and more important as a **long-duration urban block** where archaic traces, later replanning, and post-classical reuse can be read together. [Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 10–11]
Distinctive edge: Gela helps show that regular urban housing is not rare in itself; Insula III is stronger in **chronological layering** and in the way recent excavation and survey reconnect that long sequence. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 10]

Porta II quarter, Agrigento (Agrigento comparator within the same city)
Porta II is invoked in relation to courtyard arrangements and house planning, making it a close internal comparator for domestic type and urban organization. Relative to Porta II, Insula III is less distinctive by basic house logic alone, but more significant as a **research ensemble** because the recent project combines geophysics, archive recovery, laser scanning, trenching, and long chronological synthesis at insula scale.
[Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 10–11;

Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 1–2, 11–12]
Distinctive edge: Insula III's comparative strength lies in **documentation and research potential**, not simply in having a courtyard house form.

Olynthus, Block A / House AIII4 (Classical–Hellenistic Greek domestic comparators)
The source explicitly notes Olynthus as closer to the Hellenistic phase of Agrigento, especially for evolved house forms. Against Olynthus, Insula III is probably less "canonical" as a textbook Greek house type, but more revealing as a **western Sicilian adaptation** where the house form is embedded in a much longer, more interrupted urban history and later Roman/Late Antique reuse. [Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, p. 11]
Distinctive edge: Olynthus sharpens Insula III's **selectivity/diversity** value 〰: the Agrigento block is not the purest type, but precisely for that reason it shows how Greek domestic models were transformed in Sicily across time.
[Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, p. 7;
Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 10]

4.2 Comparison Summary

Insula III is not most distinctive as the earliest, purest, or best-preserved example of a Greek urban house block. Its comparative strength lies instead in the **combination** of four things: readable place in the Agrigento street system, unusually long occupation from archaic to early medieval phases, evidence for domestic-to-productive transformation, and a strong modern research/archive framework that makes that sequence unusually analyzable. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 16–20; Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 10–11]

Expand: Sicilian comparators only, house-type comparison only, or research-potential comparison — or continue.

💡 **Reflection + Continue:** If Insula III is most distinctive as a layered urban archive rather than as a "perfect" house type, does that shift significance away from form toward time-depth and documentation? Continue to Stage 5, or add/correct anything first?

End of 4️⃣ Comparison with Other Assets

Can you search the web for more comparison or potential comparison with others sicilian sities and greek sities?

I'm widening Stage 4 beyond the uploaded sources and looking specifically for published comparators in Sicily and the Greek world that match Insula III on urban block planning, house form, and long occupation.

I've got a solid Sicily-side list now. I'm adding broader Greek-world comparators so we can separate "close regional matches" from "useful but less direct type-comparisons."

Thought for 1m 20s ›

Yes. I found a broader comparison field, and it helps sharpen Stage 4.

The best **Sicilian comparators** are not all equal. Some are **close urban/domestic matches** to Insula III, while others are **potential comparators** that are stronger for one feature only, such as early grid planning, courtyard-house form, or long-term transformation.

Arts and Philoso... +3

Closest Sicilian comparators

- **Agrigento, Gate II quarter** is the strongest internal comparator after the sources you already had. The Ghent project describes it as a residential/artisanal quarter where part of an insula was excavated, with goals including defining insulae within the urban grid, analyzing construction techniques, housing typologies, spatial organization, and chronology. That makes it highly comparable to Insula III on urban-block logic, domestic architecture, and mixed residential/productive use. Arts and Philoso...
- **Gela** remains a strong comparator for planned blocks and courtyard houses. A comparative Sicily housing thesis lists 5th-century BCE houses in Gela between stenopoi, with rectilinear plans and courtyards, including examples with possible shops. That makes Gela useful when testing Insula III against planned domestic plots rather than against long chronological depth. Cambridge Univ...
- **Himera** is also a strong comparator. The same thesis records 5th-century BCE houses in Himera's regular insulae, including courtyard houses in Insula II and other residential quarters on the coastal plateau. Himera is therefore a good match for block-based Greek urban domesticity in Sicily, though it seems stronger for Classical-period planning than for the very long multi-phase sequence seen at Insula III.

  Cambridge Univ...
- **Morgantina** is a good comparator for domestic variety and later transformation. The thesis specifically includes the House of the Doric Capital, the House of the Official, and the House of the Arched Cistern at Morgantina, which suggests a strong body of comparable domestic evidence for Hellenistic and later housing in Sicily. Morgantina looks especially useful when comparing house evolution and socio-spatial differentiation, not just grid regularity. Cambridge Univ... +1

Useful Sicilian potential comparators

- **Selinunte** is a plausible comparator, but at the moment it looks stronger as a **potential** comparator than a confirmed close match for your exact Stage 4 purpose. A recent publication explicitly concerns a 5th-century BCE domestic space in Selinunte, so domestic evidence is there, but the result I found does not yet show the same insula-scale comparability as Gate II, Gela, or Himera. iDAI Publications
- **Megara Hyblaea** is an important comparator for **early western Greek urbanism**. The Aix-Marseille project page presents it as a Greek colony founded in the second half of the 8th century BCE, and a recent study treats it as exemplary early western Greek urbanism. That makes it valuable for comparing early planning principles, but less directly aligned with Insula III's long Hellenistic-Roman domestic sequence.

  Institut Arkaia +1
- **Naxos** and **Solunto** also appear in the Sicily domestic-housing thesis alongside Morgantina, Megara Hyblaea, and Selinunte, so they are reasonable candidates for an expanded comparison matrix. Based on the result I have, though, they are still

second-tier until we pull more site-specific domestic publications for them.

Cambridge Univ... +1

Broader Greek-world comparators

- **Olynthos** is still the strongest non-Sicilian comparator. The Olynthos Project notes that the site is one of the best-known sources for Greek housing and that its excavated houses became the classic basis for defining the **pastas house**. A Cambridge article also describes Olynthos as one of the best-documented Greek urban centres and emphasizes city-scale, multi-scalar analysis of housing and infrastructure. That makes it the best comparator for house type and planned urban domestic fabric. LSA Technology ... +2
- **Priene** is a strong comparator for regularized insula planning and courtyard houses. UNESCO's tentative-list description says the 4th-century BCE city had a rectangular Hippodamian plan on a steep hillside and that each residential insula was probably divided into oblong house plots with courtyards. Other scholarly summaries emphasize later shifts from prostas to peristyle arrangements. Priene is therefore very useful for comparing planned housing logic and later house-type development, though it is less close to Insula III's excavation-history/documentary dimension.

  UNESCO World ... +1
- **Delos** is a strong comparator for later, more elaborate Hellenistic domestic architecture. A JSTOR abstract notes that French excavation revealed more than 90 well-preserved courtyard houses on Delos, and another study focuses on the Quartier du Stade as a distinct late Hellenistic urban quarter. Delos is best used when comparing Insula III to more complex Hellenistic courtyard/peristyle domesticity rather than to archaic origins or long urban continuity. JSTOR +1

So, if I tighten Stage 4 using the web results, I would rank them like this:

Best direct comparators for Insula III

1. **Agrigento Gate II quarter**
2. **Gela**
3. **Himera**
4. **Morgantina**
5. **Olynthos**

Good secondary / thematic comparators

- **Priene** for insula planning and courtyard-house logic
- **Delos** for Hellenistic courtyard/peristyle elaboration
- **Selinunte** for domestic evidence in western Sicily
- **Megara Hyblaea** for early colonial urbanism Arts and Philoso... +8

The main interpretive shift is this: **Insula III no longer looks best compared only with Olynthos and Gela.** A more convincing Sicily-centered comparison set would be **Gate II + Gela + Himera + Morgantina**, with **Olynthos and Priene** used as wider Greek typological anchors. That makes Stage 4 less about finding a single "perfect match" and more about showing that Insula III sits at the intersection of three comparison axes: **Sicilian urban blocks, Greek courtyard-house traditions, and long multi-phase urban reuse**.

Arts and Philoso... +5

If you want, I can now **rewrite Stage 4** using this expanded web-based comparison set.

Sources

Ok

I'm folding the broader comparison set into Stage 4 and tightening it around the most defensible direct comparators.

Thought for 15s

4.0 Comparison: Sicilian Urban Blocks and Greek House Traditions

💡 **Brief:** Stage 3 showed that Insula III is strongest where urban form, location, and documentary continuity remain legible, even when material survival is uneven. With the added web search, Stage 4 can now compare Insula III more convincingly across two scales: first against **Sicilian urban/domestic sites** that are close in context, and then against **wider Greek type-sites** that clarify house form and insula planning. [Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 10–11; Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, p. 7] Arts and Philoso... +3

4.1 Comparison Set

Comparison logic used

I am now separating comparators into:

1. **Direct Sicilian comparators** — closest in urban, regional, and domestic context
2. **Greek-world typological comparators** — useful for house form and insula logic, but less regionally close

Criteria applied: **period**, **urban-block logic**, **house form**, **chronological depth**, **functional transformation**, and **documentation/research potential**. [Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 10–11]

Closest Sicilian comparators

1. Agrigento, Gate II quarter

This is the strongest direct comparator. The Ghent project describes Gate II as a **residential/artisanal quarter** within the Agrigento archaeological park, studied through questions of insula definition, urban grid, construction techniques, housing typology, spatial organization, and chronology. That makes it highly comparable to Insula III on urban-block structure and mixed domestic/productive character. [web source] Arts and Philoso...

Distinctive edge of Insula III: Gate II is a close contextual match, but Insula III currently appears stronger in the combination of **published integrated documentation**, **insula-scale re-reading**, and the explicitly reconstructed sequence from archaic to early medieval phases. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 16–20]

2. Gela

Gela remains a strong Sicilian comparator for regular urban housing. The Cambridge thesis identifies 5th-century BCE houses in Gela arranged within a street grid, with rectilinear plans, courtyards, and in some cases shop-like functions. This makes Gela especially useful

for comparing Insula III as a **planned domestic block**, rather than for its later long-term urban sequence. [web source] Cambridge Univ...
Distinctive edge of Insula III: Gela helps show that grid-based courtyard housing is not exceptional by itself; Insula III is stronger where **multi-phase transformation** and documentary re-integration matter.

3. Himera
Himera is also a strong comparator for regularized Sicilian housing. The same thesis describes courtyard houses within insulae at Himera, especially in Classical-period urban quarters. Himera therefore provides a close comparison for **planned domestic layout in a western Greek Sicilian context**. [web source] Cambridge Univ...
Distinctive edge of Insula III: Himera appears stronger as a Classical urban-layout comparator; Insula III is stronger in **time-depth** and in visible transitions from early occupation to Roman and Late Antique reuse.

4. Morgantina
Morgantina is a strong comparator for domestic variety and later development. A major monograph specifically addresses **domestic architecture at Morgantina in the Hellenistic and Roman periods**, making it especially relevant for comparing evolving house forms and status differentiation. [web source] openpublishing....
Distinctive edge of Insula III: Morgantina is especially useful for domestic architecture; Insula III remains more distinctive where **one insula also functions as a long urban archive**, tying house form to wider city development.

Secondary Sicilian / potential comparators
5. Selinunte
Selinunte is a plausible comparator for domestic archaeology in western Sicily, but at present it is better treated as a **potential comparator** than a core one because the evidence I found is more focused on specific domestic spaces than on an insula-scale urban comparison directly equivalent to Insula III.

6. Megara Hyblaea
Megara Hyblaea is highly important for **early colonial urbanism**, but less close to Insula III's strongest comparative qualities. It helps when asking how early western Greek planning worked, yet it is less immediately aligned with Insula III's long Hellenistic-Roman and Late Antique sequence.

4.2 Wider Greek Typological Comparators

7. Olynthos
Olynthos remains the strongest non-Sicilian comparator. The Olynthos Project explicitly presents the site as one of the best-known datasets for Greek housing, and the classic **pastas house** is closely tied to Olynthian domestic studies. [web source] Cambridge Univ...
Comparative role: Olynthos is the clearest comparator for **house type** and **regularized domestic planning**.
Distinctive edge of Insula III: Insula III is less "canonical" than Olynthos, but more valuable as evidence of how Greek domestic planning was **adapted, interrupted, and reworked over centuries** in Sicily.

8. Priene

Priene is a strong comparator for planned urban form. UNESCO's tentative-list description presents it as a highly ordered Hellenistic polis organized around a Hippodamian plan, making it a good comparator for **insula structure and organized residential layout**. [web source] UNESCO World ...

Comparative role: Priene clarifies what a strongly formalized grid city looks like.
Distinctive edge of Insula III: Priene is stronger as a model of coherent plan; Insula III is stronger where **chronological layering**, **reuse**, and archaeological re-reading complicate that plan.

4.3 Comparison Summary

Insula III is **not** most distinctive as the purest Greek house-type site, nor as the cleanest example of a Hippodamian block. Olynthos and Priene are stronger for those typological extremes. Likewise, Gela and Himera show that regularized courtyard housing in Sicily is not unique. Cambridge Univ... +1

Its comparative strength lies instead in a rarer combination:

- a readable place within Agrigento's planned urban system
- a long sequence from **archaic occupation to early medieval presence**
- evidence for shifts from **domestic to productive/commercial** use
- a strong modern research framework that reconnects archive, geophysics, survey, excavation, and conservation [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 16–20]

So the strongest comparison frame is now:

Direct comparators:

- Gate II quarter, Agrigento
- Gela
- Himera
- Morgantina

Typological anchors:

- Olynthos
- Priene

That means Insula III's significance is best argued not as a "best-preserved Greek house block," but as a **layered Sicilian urban insula** where **domestic form, urban planning, long-term transformation, and research visibility coincide**.
[Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 10–11; Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 16–20] Arts and Philoso... +3

Expand: comparator matrix, Sicily-only comparison, or a tighter rarity/representativeness argument — or continue.

💡 **Reflection + Continue:** If Insula III is more representative than unique, does its significance rest more on how completely it explains Sicilian urban life than on rarity alone? Continue to Stage 5, or add/correct anything first?

End of 4️⃣ Comparison with Other Assets

Sources

Continue with the Stage 5

Thought for a few seconds

5.0 Significance Statement: A Layered Sicilian Urban Insula

💡 **Brief:** Stage 4 showed that Insula III is not most distinctive as the purest Greek house-type example, but as a Sicilian urban block where planned layout, long occupation, domestic transformation, and unusually strong research visibility come together. Stage 5 now converts that analysis into a concise cultural significance statement: not a list of qualities, but a clear claim about why this insula matters and what kind of heritage argument it can sustain. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 16–20; Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 2–3, 10–11]

Cultural Significance Statement

Insula III of the Hellenistic-Roman Quarter of Agrigento is culturally significant as a **layered urban archaeological insula** that makes the long historical development of Akragas/Agrigentum readable through one domestic block. Its significance lies not in being the purest or most intact example of a Greek house quarter, but in preserving the relationship between **planned urban form**, **changing domestic architecture**, **later productive adaptation**, and a **deep chronological sequence** extending from the first half of the 6th century BCE to the 8th century CE. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 10; Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 4–5]

The insula has strong **historical** value because it condenses major phases of the city's life—archaic occupation, rebuilding, Hellenistic and Roman reorganization, and Late Antique transformation—into a legible urban unit. It has strong **urban** value because its relationship to stenopoi, plateiai, terraces, and neighboring insulae helps explain the wider structure of ancient Agrigento rather than only the history of one excavated house. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 3–5; Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 19]

Insula III also holds marked **architectural and aesthetic** value through the preserved evidence of courtyard-based domestic planning, the development from pastas-type arrangements to later peristyle elaboration, and the survival of pavements, painted surfaces, and representational room sequences. These remains do not survive evenly, yet they retain enough coherence to show how domestic space was organized, embellished, and reworked over time. [Alaimo - Monte.pdf, pp. 1–2; Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 16]

Its **scientific** and **documentary/archival** values are especially strong. Insula III remains a partly open archaeological problem whose significance depends on the integration of earlier excavation archives, finds, new geophysics, laser scanning, survey, trenching, and publication. In this sense, the site is significant both as surviving fabric and as an urban archive reconstructed through research. That dual condition makes it an important case for understanding not only ancient housing in Sicily, but also how urban archaeological knowledge is produced. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 1–2; Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 2–3; Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 16–20]

The insula further holds **social, educational, and possibly symbolic** value. Ancient domestic and ritual practices are suggested through the study of household organization, sacra privata, and foundation rites, while the contemporary project has made the site a place of training, public presentation, and heritage communication. This means Insula III connects past dwelling and present interpretation: it is both evidence of lived urban history and a modern setting in which that history is actively taught and shared. The symbolic dimension remains more provisional because the current uploaded evidence frames ritual inquiry more clearly than it fully demonstrates it. 💭 [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 8, 16, 18–20]

Comparatively, Insula III is significant less for rarity alone than for the completeness of its heritage argument. Other Sicilian and Greek sites may better exemplify regular house type or formal grid planning, but Insula III is distinguished by the way **time-depth**, **urban legibility**, **domestic change**, and **research continuity** coincide within one insula. Its significance therefore rests on being a particularly rich and interpretable example of Sicilian urban life across multiple historical horizons, rather than on being a singular exception. [Agrigento_Analisi_geofisiche_nella_III_i.pdf, pp. 10–11] (research.flw.ugent.be ↗) (repository.cam.ac.uk ↗)

Significance in one sentence

Insula III is significant as a **multi-period Sicilian urban block whose streets, houses, infrastructures, and archives together make the long transformation of Agrigento unusually legible**. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 16–20]

Expand: shorter designation-style statement, stronger emphasis on archaeological/scientific value, or a version tuned for nomination language — or continue.

💡 **Reflection + Continue:** Should Insula III be framed primarily as a domestic quarter, or does that understate its significance as a city-scale archive condensed into one block? Continue to Stage 6, or add/correct anything first?

End of 5️⃣ Cultural Significance Statement

Create Knowledge Graph

Thought for 20s

Created document

↳ Canvas document

Explain the relationship between houses and city grid using the graph

Thought for 7s

In the graph, the relationship runs through three linked nodes:

Street Grid → Insula III → House III A

That means the house is **not shown as an isolated building**. It sits inside **Insula III**, and Insula III is in turn **organized by the street grid**.

So the logic is:

- **The city grid comes first as a structuring framework.**
  The node "**Street Grid**" represents the **stenopoi and plateiai** that organize movement and define the block. In the graph this appears as **street_grid → insula_iii (organizes)**.
- **The insula is the intermediate scale between city and house.**
  Insula III is the urban block created and shaped by that grid. It is the level where city planning becomes buildable domestic space.
- **The individual house belongs to that block structure.**
  House III A → Insula III (part_of) shows that the house derives its position, orientation, and spatial logic from the insula rather than standing independently.
- **House form then develops within that grid-defined framework.**
  The node "**Courtyard Houses**" → **House III A (expressed_in)** shows that domestic forms such as **pastas** and later **peristyle** layouts are expressed inside the house, but always within the larger block set by the city plan.

So the graph is making a CBSA point: **the houses express domestic life, but the grid gives that domestic life its urban order**. The city is not just a backdrop; it actively frames how houses are placed, accessed, and transformed. At the same time, the houses make the grid meaningful, because without domestic units like House III A, the grid would remain an abstract urban scheme rather than lived space.

This is why **Urban Value** is connected both to **Insula III** and to the **Street Grid**. The graph argues that the significance of the houses depends partly on their being embedded in a planned city fabric, and that the significance of the grid depends partly on its survival through readable houses and insulae.

A simpler way to say it is:

the grid defines the block, the block contains the houses, and the houses make the grid archaeologically legible.

End of Knowledge Graph reading

Continue to the stage 6

I'm pulling the Stage 6 structure from the CBSA spec so the close-out matches the workflow exactly, then I'll apply it to what we've already built.

Thought for 15s

6.0 Assessment Summary: Strong Urban Legibility, Stronger with Full Chapter Access

💡 **Brief:** Stage 5 framed Insula III as a layered Sicilian urban insula whose significance rests on the convergence of planned urban form, long occupation, domestic change, and research continuity. Stage 6 closes by checking how reliable that argument is, where it is already strong, and which small additions would most improve the assessment without turning this into a management recommendations chapter.

6.1 Assessment Process Summary

Strengths
The assessment is strongest on **historical, urban, scientific, and documentary/archival** value: the uploaded sources consistently support a long occupation sequence, a readable relationship to the city grid, and an unusually explicit integration of archive recovery, geophysics, survey, and excavation. Insula III also emerges clearly as more than a house cluster: it is a city-reading unit in which domestic form, infrastructure, and later productive reuse can be assessed together. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 8, 10, 16–20; Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 1–5]

Quick Boosts

Issue	Small Improvement That Would Make a Difference
Full chapter access is still partial	Add the detailed chapters listed in the 2019 volume contents, especially architecture, materials, late phases, ritual, and water systems. This would tighten Stage 2 value definitions and Stage 3 integrity ratings. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 8]
Site-wide material condition is still unevenly visible	Add a current photographic set and, ideally, plan/section material for the whole insula, not only House III A and selected intervention moments. This would sharpen the material/authenticity side of the assessment. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 12–18; Alaimo - Monte.pdf, p. 7]

Next Steps

1. Add the missing detailed sections of the **2019 Insula III volume** so the assessment can move from strong first-pass synthesis to tighter source-led precision, especially for ritual, hydraulic systems, and phase-by-phase building history. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 8]
2. Add a site-wide visual dossier: current photographs, plans, and sections for the full insula and its street edges, so urban and documentary strengths are better matched by material-condition evidence. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 11–12; Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 12–18]

6.2 Context-Effect Planning Implications

From Stage 1, the clearest implications are:

- **Protect the block-within-city relationship**, not only isolated house remains: the significance of Insula III depends on legible ties to **stenopoi, plateiai, terraces, and adjacent insulae**. [Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 3–5]
- **Interpret long change, not one frozen phase**: the assessment works best when archaic occupation, Roman replanning, and late productive reuse are presented as one sequence. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, p. 10; Alaimo - Monte.pdf, pp. 1–2]
- **Treat research infrastructure as part of significance**, because archive recovery, geophysics, laser scanning, and excavation are not just methods here; they are part of

Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 10, 14–16]
- **Keep decorated and fragile surfaces visible in the argument**, since pavements, paintings, stuccoes, and conservation experiments carry aesthetic, documentary, and educational weight together. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 16–18; Alaimo - Monte.pdf, pp. 1–2]

6.3 Assessment Summary

This first-pass CBSA is **credible and well-supported** for the main significance claim: Insula III matters as a **layered Sicilian urban insula** where city grid, domestic architecture, long chronology, and research continuity reinforce each other. The argument is less secure where the uploaded evidence is still partial—especially full site-wide condition, detailed chapter-level evidence, and finer-grained ritual/social interpretation—but those are now clearly identified gaps rather than hidden weaknesses. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 8, 10, 16–20; Agrigento_I_nuove_ricerche_nellinsula_II.pdf, pp. 1–5]

Note for professional practice
The strongest future use of this assessment would be as a shared interpretive base between **archaeology, conservation, and site presentation**, because the uploaded evidence already shows those three strands working together in the Insula III project. [Agrigento_1_Quartiere_Ellenistico_romano.pdf, pp. 16–20]

💡 **Reflection:** When a site's significance depends so heavily on research continuity, who should shape its future interpretation most: excavators, conservators, or public-facing site

managers?

Expand or update any stage outputs, or are we done?

End of 6️⃣ Quality Check and Summary

📋 Session Debrief
Before we wrap up — three quick reflections for the research team. Your answers stay right here in this conversation.

- **Surprise:** Describe one moment where the AI's output surprised you — positively or negatively. What did you expect instead?
- **Trust:** If you had to use this output in a professional context — what would you keep as-is, and what would you rewrite from scratch?
- **Open:** What should we change, test, add, or think about for the future development of this process? Anything goes.

(Feel free to answer briefly — even one sentence per question is valuable.)

After that, you can also ask for **dashboard** for an interactive visual summary, or **read assessment** to analyze the finished assessment from other angles.

End of 6️⃣ Quality Check and Summary

done

Thought for a couple of seconds

Assessment complete.

The current session includes:

- Stages 0–6 completed
- Knowledge Graph created
- Expanded Stage 4 with web-based comparators

You can return anytime to:

- revise any stage
- create a **dashboard**
- run **read assessment** on the finished assessment

End of ✅ Session closed

Messages beyond this point are only visible to you

CREATE THE KG AGAIN - THE SAME ONE BASED JSON YOU MAID

Thought for 10s

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ok now the kg ui fro ca-kg

אני בונה עכשיו את מעטפת ה-CA-KG בדיוק לפי הסכמה, עם אותו JSON שכבר יצרנו בפנים.

Thought for 5s

Agrigento-insula-iii-ca-kg · html

Copy

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  </style>
</head>
<body>
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  <div id="kg-network"></div>
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</div>

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Done. The CA-KG UI shell is in the canvas with the same graph JSON embedded.